Beztak Operations Manual

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Beztak (Oakland Management Corp.)

This is a text copy of the manual in the question-and-answer form the Beztakets assistant answers from, made so it can be read in the app. Links to internal systems, the office address and phone number, and "click here" instruction links are left out on purpose. The original manual is the version to follow if anything differs.

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1. Who to Contact

1.1 Where do I send HR questions (benefits, pay, PTO, FMLA, Paycor login, time clock)?

Log all requests about benefits, pay amounts, PTO time, FMLA, disability, Paycor login or password resets, and time clock issues or punch errors through the HR email: HR@beztak.com.

1.2 Who handles recruiting help?

Managers who want to sponsor a post on Indeed or need help with full-cycle recruiting for a role email recruiting@beztak.com.

1.3 Who do I contact about training and Yardi eLearning?

Questions about Yardi eLearning logins, passwords and courses go to training@beztak.com.

1.4 When should I contact the Help Desk?

The Help Desk (helpdesk@beztak.com, IT and Yardi) is for when technology, hardware or software is not working correctly, including marketing websites, marketing system errors, and pricing or lead tracking issues. System training questions (Yardi, Payscan and so on) go to your supervisor, not the Help Desk. Do not email anyone directly.

1.5 Where do marketing requests go?

Floor plans, collateral design, sign packages, new property websites, online presence and recommendations for new marketing resources go through mrequests@beztak.com.

1.6 Where do I send security deposit (SODA) questions?

Questions about a SODA (Statement of Deposit Accounting) go to SDRefunds@beztak.com, not to an individual property accountant.

1.7 Who handles vendor setup, vendor insurance and vendor payments?

Questions about adding a vendor, updating vendor insurance, inviting a vendor to Vendor Café and vendor payments go to Vendor Maintenance: VendorMain@beztak.com.

2. Rent Collections

2.1 When is rent due?

Under Section 4 of the Beztak lease, residents agree to pay rent on or before the first day of each month, without needing a reminder.

2.2 What are the rent collection standards?

- Rent must be paid in full; partial rent is never accepted.
- 75% of rent should be collected within the first 7 days of the month.
- Delinquent rent at the end of the financial period should not exceed 0.75% of total income booked for the month; the goal is 0.50%.
- At month end, all check batches are mailed to the corporate office accounting department.

2.3 What payment methods are accepted for rent?

Rent must be paid electronically. Accepted methods: ACH through BILT, credit card (additional fees may apply), certified check (additional fees may apply), Flex Pay, and Pay Near Me / WIPS (Walk-In Payment System). Personal checks and money orders are not accepted. Cashier's checks may only be used after the 7th or by anyone with an NSF, and must be scanned within 24 hours of receipt.

2.4 What is the convenience fee?

Cashier's checks and payments not set up on automatic withdrawal carry a $10 convenience fee per payment, added to the tenant's account. Residents should set up auto-pay before move-in; otherwise the $10 fee is added as a recurring fee for the whole lease term.

2.5 How do late fees work?

Late fees are charged when rent is not paid as agreed, using the late fee function in Yardi. Fees may vary by state regulations and owner preference; see Section 4 of the lease agreement.

2.6 When are legal fees applied?

Legal fees are applied to a resident's account when the file is sent to an attorney to file with court, and should be applied by the 15th of the month. They vary by jurisdiction, so confirm the charges with your attorney.

2.7 What is an NSF and what do I do about it?

A Non-Sufficient Funds (NSF) payment is one returned by the bank (no money in the account, a closed account, a disputed payment, or wrong bank details). Review the Collect Dashboard in Yardi for payments that need handling, and add late fees and legal fees to the account when a resident NSFs, if applicable.

2.8 What are manual deposits?

Checks that cannot be processed through the office check scanner: physical cashier's checks that cause scanning errors, and ACH deposits from Housing Assistance Programs (HAP) or similar third parties. A check that cannot be processed must be taken to the bank immediately; if the bank is not local, coordinate with your accountant to mail it promptly.

3. Renewals, Notices and Move-Out

3.1 What are the lease renewal standards?

- Know the owner's objective: raising rents or keeping occupancy.
- Renew all leases at least 75 days before expiration.
- Aim to bring residents to market rent; for residents already over market, the regional manager and owner set the % cap.
- Renewal incentives are a last resort and need VP approval in writing.
- The Regional, VP and Owners approve all recommended renewal rates.
- Residents get personal contact before renewal rates are updated.
- Renewal letters are usually generated 60-90 days before the lease expires.

3.2 What is an onsite transfer?

An onsite transfer is when a current or on-notice resident moves to another unit in the same property. It is done with the onsite transfer function in Yardi.

3.3 What is a roommate promotion?

A roommate promotion happens with a lease assignment, when the primary leaseholder moves out and the remaining roommate(s) stay in the unit.

3.4 What is the process when a resident gives notice to vacate?

- Contact each resident personally to try to save the lease.
- Get a written notice to vacate signed by all leaseholders within the time frame in the lease.
- Do a pre-move-out inspection no less than 10 days before move-out.
- Residents who end their lease early are charged according to their lease; in Michigan they must choose their early termination option in writing.

3.5 How does the move-out and collection process work?

The move-out process is completed within 48 hours. A move-out inspection identifies damages and charges; residents are told about the charges and can pay or dispute them under state law. Security deposit refunds are issued per state regulations, and any balance owed after move-out goes to the debt collection process.

3.6 When must a SODA (Statement of Deposit Accounting) be completed, and where does it go?

- SODAs must be completed within 7 days of move-out.
- SODAs that need a refund are sent to SDRefunds@beztak.com.
- SODAs that leave a balance are mailed to the resident at the forwarding address given at move-out.

3.7 When do balances go to collections?

Past-resident balances of $100 or more go to collections within 14 days of move-out if not paid. Writing off an account is a two-day process: day one, mark it for collections in Yardi; day two, complete the write-off once confirmation is received.

4. Expenses and Purchasing

4.1 What are the expense standards?

- Expenses may not exceed approved budget guidelines without the Owner's advance written approval.
- Purchase orders (POs) are required for all purchases before buying.
- Vendors add invoices through Vendor Café; the site processes them in Yardi (P2P Finance Manager role). Utility, legal and municipality invoices are batched and scanned daily.
- Expense and mileage reports are due within 30 days after the end of the month the expense occurred.

4.2 When is a purchase order (PO) required?

A PO is required before any work is done by a vendor, to stay on budget and process invoices, except for emergencies and utility bills. POs are created manually (P2P Finance Manager role) or through Yardi Marketplace. Work should not start until the PO has final approval.

4.3 What are manual POs, Marketplace POs, service contracts and recurring POs?

- Manual POs: for work like turnovers, plumbing and heating/cooling repairs; receive the PO in Yardi once the service is done.
- Marketplace POs: all parts must be ordered from Yardi Marketplace for competitive pricing.
- Service contracts: entered in Yardi for monthly or recurring services with a contract, such as advertising or lawn care.
- Recurring POs: for recurring services without a contract, such as office or hallway cleaning.

4.4 How do vendors get set up and paid?

All vendors (except special cases such as city inspections or utilities) upload invoices through Vendor Café. To add a vendor, the vendor completes a new vendor packet, the site manager sends it to Vendor Maintenance, accounting enters the vendor in Yardi, and the vendor gets an invitation to set up a Vendor Café account.

4.5 What are the petty cash rules?

- Petty cash is for site expenses that cannot be ordered in Yardi Marketplace, such as resident functions, refreshments, gas for site trucks and postage.
- Keep it locked and secure in the office or in a bank account; Green Dot cards are preferred.
- Submit it when 50% has been spent, and at least once a month.
- Maintenance items need written approval from the Regional Manager.
- It is not used to reimburse mileage; use an Expense Report.
- Amount on hand: 0-300 units $300; 301-599 units $500; 600+ units $750.

4.6 How is petty cash reconciled, and what happens when a manager leaves?

Receipts plus cash on hand must equal the starting amount (for example $250 receipts + $250 cash = $500). Enter it in P2P Finance Manager as a manual invoice with the Petty Cash Reconciliation Form. With a Green Dot card, send Petty Cash Expense Reports to your Property Accountant. A departing Property Manager reconciles on their last day, and shortages are deducted from the final paycheck; on a manager change, both Property Managers and the Regional Manager sign off.

4.7 How do expense reports work?

Expense reports are for travel and other company-related purchases and need valid receipts. The associate must be added to Yardi as a vendor to be paid: email Vendor Maintenance (vendormain@beztak.com). Check with your supervisor whether the report is processed as an invoice or sent directly to accounting. Reports are due within 30 days after the end of the month of the expense.

4.8 When is a Bid Approval Form needed?

For all contracted work over $5,000. Property or Service Managers collect comparable bids from three vendors and send the form to the Regional Manager to present to ownership.

4.9 Who can sign contracts, and what are the contract rules?

- Only VPs, the President, COO, Partner and Owner may sign a contract.
- Contracts are written under the legal name of the community, never under Oakland Management Corp. or Beztak.
- Recurring monthly contracts are limited to one year without auto-renewal.
- Include current insurance and W-9s, use the Service Contract Recap sheet as a cover sheet, and attach all contracts to the vendor in Yardi.
- Keep executed copies in the Community Development binder.
- No significant capital work without a contract and specific warranties. Approved templates are in DocuSign.

5. Site Team Standards, Timecards and Bonuses

5.1 What are the standards for site employees?

- Follow the Beztak standard office set-up; use leasing tablets for leasing.
- Comply with the Beztak Ensemble Program; always wear name badges when representing Beztak.
- Property and Service Managers meet daily to set priorities; Property Managers hold weekly staff meetings.
- Quarterly safety meetings hosted by the Risk Managers are required, and attendance is noted in writing.

5.2 How does recruiting and hiring work for a property?

Recruiting can be done in-house by posting the job in Paycor, or by using a Beztak Recruiter for an extra fee billed to the property. To use a recruiter, the Regional Manager emails Recruiting@beztak.com.

5.3 When must timecards be approved before they lock?

Timecards must be approved by 10:00 a.m. EST on the Monday of a pay week. After that they lock and cannot be changed; later edits need a Timecard Correction Form emailed to HR@beztak.com. Monitor timecards during the week for errors and missing punches, approve PTO requests promptly, and review on-call hours.

5.4 When are bonuses paid and what are the deadlines?

Bonuses (leasing/renewal commissions, quarterly bonuses and on-call bonuses) are paid on the second check of each month. Use the latest template HR emails. Property Managers send completed templates to their Regional Managers by 3:00 p.m. EST on the Wednesday before payroll is due; Regional Managers send approved templates to HR@beztak.com by 3:00 p.m. EST on Friday.

5.5 How are uniforms and boots ordered?

Property Managers order maintenance and office uniforms through ICO. HR starts Spring and Fall reorders by email; employees view the lookbook and give their order to their Property Manager. Maintenance and grounds staff can get one new pair of boots per year from Shoes for Crews.

5.6 How does corrective action work?

Attendance forms are for unexcused absences, tardiness, no-call no-shows (under three days), leaving without permission and on-call infractions, and should be done immediately. Coaching covers growth areas. Corrective Action / Final Corrective Action forms are for serious infractions (such as attendance, performance, insubordination, violence, dishonesty, harassment, theft, drugs or alcohol, property damage, dress code or safety violations). A Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) sets out a structured improvement plan. Email all completed forms to HR@beztak.com.

5.7 What are the mystery shop standards?

A third party mystery shops properties monthly, and the phone shop is recorded for feedback. Employees must score 85% or higher on the Ellis shop and 100% on benchmarks (asking for the name, phone number and application). A shop below 90% means a written warning and the "How to Ace Your Shop" training; a second shop below 85% results in termination. Sales staff must keep a 75% phone-to-appointment ratio and a 35% tour-to-rental ratio.

6. Operations Reports

6.1 What regular reports do property managers complete?

- Monday Morning Report (MMR): every Monday, updates ownership on the past week.
- Reclass/Accruals: at month end, reviewed Monday mornings.
- Month End Checklist: in HappyCo during the last week of the month.
- Owner's Report: mid-month, on performance, financials and expenses.
- Rate Adjustment Form (RAF): tracks rate changes and specials; adjustments run Thursday to Wednesday.
- 3-Year Plan: updated yearly with the budget, kept in the Community Development binder.

7. Leasing, Marketing and Customer Service

7.1 What are the customer service standards?

- Respond to resident requests within 24 hours.
- Return phone, email and other messages the day they are received.
- Online reviews must reflect 4.0+ ratings.
- Annual resident satisfaction plans are required.
- Greet residents by name and with a smile; personal contact is preferred.

7.2 How fast must we respond to prospects and e-leads, and how do we greet and follow up?

- Greet every prospect and offer refreshments on arrival and during every tour.
- Enter guest card data on the leasing tablet, never on paper.
- Respond to e-leads within 2 hours; process prospect calls and call-center messages daily.
- Thank-you call within 24 hours of every live tour, 72-hour follow-up by phone or email, and same-day follow-up on all inquiries.
- Goals: 50% first contact to appointment, 75% appointment to tour, 35% tours to leases.

7.3 What are the Preferred Employer and Hometown Hero programs?

Preferred Employers receive waived application fees. Hometown Heroes (military, police, firefighters, teachers, hospital staff, EMS) also receive waived fees.

7.4 What marketing tools does Beztak use?

Knock (CRM), Elise (an AI leasing assistant), listing sites (Apartments.com/CoStar, Zillow, Apartment List, Weblisters), SOCi for reputation management, Yardi Revenue IQ for pricing, Perq and ResiDesk. Marketing materials are ordered through Lloyd Waters.

8. Fair Housing and Accommodations

8.1 What are the Fair Housing requirements?

- All associates complete Fair Housing training within one week of employment.
- Lease to every qualified prospect without regard to race, color, religion, sex, handicap, familial status or national origin, and treat everyone consistently.
- All documents for prospects and residents carry the Fair Housing logo, and a company Fair Housing sign is displayed in a public area approved by the Regional Manager.

8.2 How are reasonable accommodation requests handled?

Residents may use the Reasonable Accommodation Request Form or any form with the same information. Forward every request to the Regional Manager immediately; no response goes to the resident until the Regional Manager has reviewed it and given direction. Upload all requests, documents and decisions to the resident's Yardi profile.

8.3 What is the policy on assistance animals?

Assistance animals are not pets, so no pet fees or deposits may be charged. Treat every request as a reasonable accommodation request. Most communities use third-party pet screening; otherwise the person must establish the disability and the animal's training (a letter from a medical professional or the accommodation form). Do not deny an incomplete request outright: explain what is missing and give a time frame, and involve the Regional Manager before treating it as withdrawn.

8.4 Do we accept Section 8 or other government income?

Yes. Beztak accepts all forms of legal, verifiable income at every community. If asked, the approved answer is: "We accept all forms of legal, verifiable income, all of which is qualified using a standard screening process and rental criteria." Qualify it like an offer letter (an original computer-generated benefit letter with start date and monthly amount), or the screening model can calculate it after 2 consecutive months of deposits.

9. Applications and Leases

9.1 How fast must applications be approved, and what are the application standards?

- Applications are submitted online and must pass ID verification (government ID and a selfie) first.
- Approve or decline within 72 hours of submission.
- Application fees are paid online before a unit is taken off the market.
- Screen everyone 18 and over using the property's Yardi Rental Screening Criteria; use Yardi Verification of Income.
- Attach denials and cancellations in Yardi within 24 hours.

9.2 How fast must a lease be signed after approval?

The lease must be generated and signed online within 24 hours of approval, and the lease and application attached in Yardi within 24 hours.

9.3 How long can we hold an apartment?

The Lost Rent Days standard is 7 days or less (a maximum, not an average). See the Rate Adjustment Form (RAF) for hold times and short-term fees.

10. Maintenance: Inspections and Logs

10.1 What inspection reports are done in HappyCo?

- Move Out Checklist: by the Service Manager within 24 hours of move-out, with photos.
- Make Ready Checklist: by the technician when the unit is ready.
- Final Move In Checklist: by the Property Manager before move-in.
- Light Inspection: every two weeks, at night.
- Preventative Maintenance: twice a year, in April and October.
- Seasonal Checklists: quarterly.
- Facilities Site Visit report: by the Facilities Director.

10.2 What weather and pool logs are required?

Kept by the Service Manager in a binder on the property: the Inclement Weather Log three times daily, October through March; the Snow Log daily (even with no snow), October through March; the Storm Log as hazards arise; and pool logs, testing the pool at least daily.

11. Work Orders and On-Call

11.1 How fast must work orders be completed?

Routine service requests are completed within 24 hours, or 48 hours if a part is on order or a contractor is needed. If work cannot be completed, contact the resident and document the follow-up in a memo. Water infiltration and mold are high priority, and excessive cases are emergencies.

11.2 What is the 24-Hour Maintenance Guarantee?

For routine interior repairs only: if a technician does not respond within 24 hours, the resident gets a rent credit for each day or part of a day beyond the guarantee, up to five days. If a service date is given and the repair goes past it, the same daily credit applies.

11.3 How fast must on-call respond to an emergency?

Emergency calls are answered immediately, and the on-call Service Technician should arrive within 30 minutes. If a vendor is called, the on-call associate stays on site until they arrive. The Service Manager manages the on-call rotation.

11.4 What is on-call pay, and what is the on-call bonus?

- Hourly: regular rate up to 40 hours worked per week, 1.5 times after 40. Two hours of straight-time pay automatically for being on call; two hours minimum for the first call and for each additional drive out. Plus a $100 bonus for taking on-call 3-7 days in a week.
- Salaried: a $200 bonus for taking on-call 3-7 days in a week.

More than one bonus per month is possible.

11.5 Are master locks allowed?

No. Master locks are not permitted anywhere on the property; each apartment has its own unique lock that only its own key opens.

12. Curb Appeal and Make Ready

12.1 What are the curb appeal and pool opening standards?

- Keep all areas clean and litter-free; inspect Priority One areas daily.
- Water grass and plantings daily; change seasonal plantings in Spring, Summer and Fall.
- Holiday lighting is white only in Priority One areas, and decorations need owner approval.
- Signs and lights in Priority One areas must work every night; keep lighting logs.
- Pools open by April 15 (weather permitting) until about October 15 in northern states.
- Replace damaged turf with sod, not seed, in high-priority areas, by 5/15.

12.2 How many days do we have to make an apartment ready after move-out, and what are the make ready standards?

- Change locks (and electronic codes) within 24 hours of move-out.
- Make apartments ready within four business days of move-out (weekend move-outs count from Monday); the Regional Manager can grant exceptions.
- Never scavenge parts, appliances, cabinets or doors from another apartment.
- Walk vacant units bi-weekly for damage, water or mold.
- Complete the Make Ready and Final Move In Checklists in HappyCo. The Market Ready goal is 100%.
- Schedule a pre-walk at least a week before move-out.

12.3 How should vacant apartments be kept?

Fall and winter: no warmer than 65 degrees. Spring and summer: no cooler than 75 degrees. Water heaters on the lowest ("Vacation") setting, refrigerators on the lowest setting (usually 1-3), blinds closed, windows and doors locked. Inspect weekly to remove circulars. If a unit will be off-market longer than the standard 96 hours, enter a memo on the unit.

13. HR Policies

13.1 When does the work week start and end?

The work week starts at 12:00 a.m. Saturday and runs until 11:59 p.m. the following Friday.

13.2 What are the time clock rules?

Every non-exempt (hourly) employee clocks in and out at the start and end of the shift, and for any break longer than 20 minutes. If you miss a punch, tell your supervisor immediately. You are responsible for making sure your timesheet is accurate each week.

13.3 What meal and rest breaks do I get?

A one-hour (60-minute) unpaid meal break each day you work more than four hours, plus two 15-minute paid rest breaks.

13.4 How does overtime and comp time work?

Non-exempt hourly employees get one and one-half times their hourly rate for time worked over 40 hours in a week. Comp time must be taken in the same pay period it is earned; otherwise it is added to hours worked that period. Comp time for salaried employees is at the manager's discretion.

13.5 When is payday?

Payroll is bi-weekly, with paydays every other Friday. Each paycheck covers the two-week period ending the Friday before payday. The payroll calendar is in Egnyte.

13.6 What are the rules for bonuses when someone leaves?

Bonuses are paid on the second payroll of each month, and you must be employed when they are paid out. If you resign with proper notice and work your notice period, you can receive earned leasing bonuses or commissions for up to 30 days after your last day. Resigning without notice or termination for cause means no commissions or bonuses beyond the final paycheck.

13.7 What is the dress code?

The company provides uniforms and name tags. Office and maintenance uniforms are bought twice a year (Spring and Fall) through ICO Uniforms by the Property Manager, and maintenance boots once a year through Shoes for Crews. Office and leasing staff wear proper business attire at all times. Not every ownership group participates, so check with your Regional Manager. For uniform help, email HR@beztak.com.

13.8 How does paid time off (PTO) work?

All regular full-time and part-time site employees accrue PTO. You can use it for vacation, sick time, family needs, personal affairs or rest. The amount depends on length of service; current PTO policies are in Egnyte.

13.9 Which holidays are paid?

Generally New Year's Day, Memorial Day, Independence Day, Labor Day, Thanksgiving Day and Christmas Day; the list is published each year. Full-time hourly employees who must work a holiday get 1.5 times their regular rate plus holiday pay. To get holiday pay you must work your scheduled hours the day before and after the holiday (pre-approved time off excepted). The holiday calendar is in Egnyte.

13.10 What do I do if I will be absent or late?

Notify your immediate manager at least two hours before your workday starts and give the reason, by text, email or phone (whichever your manager prefers); social media is not accepted. Make sure the message was received: if there is no reply, call your manager.

13.11 Where do I find bereavement, jury duty, FMLA and other leave policies?

They are in the Employee Handbook in Egnyte. Questions about leaves of absence go to HR@beztak.com.

13.12 Where is the Employee Handbook and my job description?

The latest Employee Handbook and current policies are in Egnyte. Your signed job description is in your Paycor file, or ask HR@beztak.com.